



With amazing fetal images and fascinating facts, you can follow your baby's development throughout your pregnancy.

Labor and birth

One of the best ways to cope with labor is to understand its stages. In the labor and birth chapter, a team of professionals covers in detail the progress of labor, each providing their own expert insight. A doctor writes about normal births and discusses natural pain relief. An anesthesiologist gives the options available for medical pain relief, including detailed descriptions of how epidurals are given and their pros and cons. While most women have a normal birth without complications, on average in the US over 30 percent have a Cesarean section, and less than 1 in 20 women have an assisted delivery, with either forceps or vacuum extraction. An obstetrician writes